🌊 Oceans of the World 🌊

3rd Grade Science Study Guide

Dive In & Learn!

What Is an Ocean?

- Oceans are huge bodies of salt water.
- They cover about 71% of Earth's surface.
- There are 5 oceans on Earth.
- Oceans are home to millions of animals and plants.
- The ocean helps control Earth's weather and temperature.

Fun Fact!

The ocean is so deep that Mount Everest could fit inside and still be covered by water!

The 5 Oceans

Pacific Ocean

Biggest ocean!
Covers more than
all land combined.

Atlantic Ocean

2nd largest ocean.
Separates America
from Europe & Africa.

Indian Ocean

3rd largest.
Warmest ocean
in the world!

Arctic Ocean

Smallest & coldest.
Mostly covered
by sea ice.

Southern Ocean

Surrounds Antarctica.
Added as the
5th ocean in 2021!

🌡️ Ocean Zones (Layers)

Sunlight Zone

0–660 ft

🐠🐬🦈 Fish, sharks, turtles

☀️ Lots of light!

Twilight Zone

660–3,300 ft

🦑🐙 Giant squid, octopus

🌑 Very dim light

Midnight Zone

3,300–13,000 ft

🦠🐟 Glowing fish, anglerfish

⚫ No light at all!

Abyss Zone

13,000–20,000 ft

🦐 Tiny shrimp, sea spiders

🥶 Freezing cold!

Amazing Ocean Animals

Blue Whale

Biggest animal
ever on Earth!

Great White Shark

Can smell blood
from a mile away!

Dolphin

Very smart — they
play and talk!

Octopus

Has 3 hearts
and blue blood!

Sea Turtle

Can live over
100 years!

Crab

Walks sideways
and has 10 legs!

💙 Why Do Oceans Matter?

🌬️ Air to Breathe

Ocean plants (phytoplankton) make over half the oxygen we breathe!

🌡️ Controls Weather

Oceans absorb heat from the sun and help keep Earth's temperature just right.

🍣 Food for People

Billions of people eat fish and seafood that come from the ocean every day.

🚢 Transportation

Ships carry goods and people across oceans connecting countries worldwide.

♻️ Protecting Our Oceans

Oceans are in danger from pollution and climate change. Here's how YOU can help:

🚫 Never litter — trash can end up in the ocean.

🛍️ Use reusable bags instead of plastic.

🚿 Save water at home.

🐟 Learn about ocean animals and share what you know.

🌱 Plant trees — they help keep oceans healthy.

📢 Tell others why oceans are so important!

Key Vocabulary

Ocean

A huge body of salt water covering most of Earth.

Salt Water

Water mixed with salt — oceans are salt water.

Phytoplankton

Tiny ocean plants that make much of our oxygen.

Zone

A layer of the ocean based on depth and light.

Current

A large stream of water moving through the ocean.

Coral Reef

An ocean structure made by tiny animals, home to many fish.